

Easy Rent Application - User Stories

1. Rental Applications & Tenant Verification

Story 1.1: Multi-Step Rental Application Form

As a prospective tenant

I want to complete a multi-step application form that captures my personal, employment, and financial details

So that I can apply for a rental property securely without being overwhelmed by a massive single-page form.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Given the user clicks "Apply Now" on a property, When the page loads, Then they should see Step 1 (Personal Details) with a progress indicator (e.g., Step 1 of 4).
- When a user clicks "Next", Then the system must validate all required fields (e.g., valid ID number, properly formatted email, no empty required fields) before allowing them to proceed to the next step.
- Given the user reaches the final step (Consent & Submission), When they submit, Then the data must be securely saved to the database with a "Pending" status.
- Edge Case: If the user drops off halfway through, their progress should be saved locally or as a draft so they can resume later without starting over.

Story 1.2: Application Fee Checkout Flow

As a prospective tenant

I want to be redirected to a payment gateway immediately after submitting my application

So that I can pay the required background check fee to finalize my application submission.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Given the user successfully submits the final step of the application, When the API returns a success response, Then the user is automatically redirected to the payment checkout page.
- Given the user completes the payment, When the payment provider confirms success, Then the application status in the database updates from "Pending Payment" to "Under Review".
- Edge Case: If the payment fails or the user cancels the checkout, the application remains in a "Pending Payment" state, and the user receives an email with a link to retry the payment.

2. Handyman Services (Maintenance)

Story 2.1: Posting a Maintenance Request

As a client (tenant or landlord)

I want to post a detailed maintenance job (including category, description, location, and photos)

So that I can accurately convey the issue to local service professionals.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Given the user is on the Handyman Dashboard, When they click "Post a New Job", Then a form appears requiring Job Title, Category (e.g., Plumbing, Electrical), Location, Budget, and Image Upload.
- When uploading images, Then the system must restrict files to .jpg or .png and limit the size to 5MB per image.
- When the job is posted, Then it immediately appears on the "Your Active Requests" board with a status tag of "Open".
- Edge Case: If a user submits a job without a budget, the system should default to "Open to quotes" rather than throwing an error.

Story 2.2: Handyman Bidding on a Job

As a handyman (service provider)

I want to view job details and submit a customized quote

So that I can compete for available maintenance jobs in my area.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Given the handyman is browsing the job board, When they click on a specific job, Then they see the full description, client location, and attached photos.
- When the handyman clicks "View & Bid", Then a modal opens allowing them to enter their proposed price, estimated time to completion, and an optional message to the client.
- When the bid is submitted, Then the client receives a real-time notification (or email) that a new quote has been received.
- Edge Case: A handyman cannot submit a bid if the job status has already been changed to "In Progress" or "Closed" by the client.

3. Service Financing

Story 3.1: Short-Term Loan Application

As a user facing unexpected maintenance costs

I want to compare financial providers and apply for a short-term advance

So that I can afford urgent repairs without draining my immediate cash flow.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Given the user clicks "Finance this repair", When the Financing page loads, Then the user sees the requested repair amount auto-filled and a list of available providers (e.g., Capitec, FNB) with their respective interest fees and payout times.
- When the user selects a provider and clicks "Continue", Then they are prompted to confirm their Employer Name and Monthly Net Income.
- When the user submits the application, Then the UI must show a loading state ("Processing Approval...") for at least 2 seconds before redirecting to the success screen to simulate external API processing.
- Edge Case: If the requested loan amount exceeds the provider's maximum limit, the specific provider button should be disabled with a tooltip explaining why.

Story 3.2: Loan Payout to Service Escrow

As a borrower

I want my approved funds to be paid directly into a Service Escrow account

So that I know the funds are secure and the handyman is guaranteed payment only when the job is actually completed.

Acceptance Criteria:

- **Given** the loan is approved on the final step, **When** the user clicks "Pay to Service Escrow", **Then** the system deducts the amount from the virtual loan balance and updates the associated Handyman Job status to "Funded".
- **Then** both the user and the hired handyman receive a notification stating "Funds Secured in Escrow".
- **Edge Case:** If the handyman fails to complete the job or the client cancels the contract, the escrow system must have a clearly defined refund trigger that sends the principal amount back to the financial provider.

4. Documents & Billing (Documents Centre)

Story 4.1: Dynamic Invoice Generation

As a landlord

I want to create a custom invoice with multiple line items (Rent, Water, Electricity)

So that I can accurately charge my tenants based on their specific monthly usage.

Acceptance Criteria:

- **Given** the landlord is in the Documents Centre, **When** they select a tenant from the dropdown, **Then** the invoice builder auto-populates the fixed base rent, locking that line item from being deleted.
- **When** the landlord clicks "Add Item", **Then** a new editable row appears allowing them to add custom charges (e.g., Water Usage) and amounts.
- **When** line item amounts are updated, **Then** the Total Amount at the bottom of the invoice must recalculate dynamically in real-time.
- **Edge Case:** The system must prevent submission if the total invoice amount is zero or negative.

Story 4.2: Auto-Scheduled Invoice Delivery

As a landlord

I want to select my delivery method and toggle "Auto-Schedule" for my invoices

So that my billing is automated on the same day every month without manual intervention.

Acceptance Criteria:

- **Given** the invoice is complete, **When** the landlord toggles "Email" and "SMS" delivery methods, **Then** the UI visually highlights the selected channels.
- **When** the landlord toggles "Auto-Schedule", **Then** the submit button text changes from "Create & Send" to "Save & Schedule".
- **When** scheduled, **Then** the system registers a cron job or scheduled task to dispatch the invoice on the 25th of the current/next month.
- **Edge Case:** If the landlord attempts to save without selecting at least one delivery method, the system must trigger a toast error saying "Please select at least one delivery method."

5. Property Search & Listing

Story 5.1: Places of Interest (POI) Distance Calculation

As a prospective tenant

I want to input my specific daily destinations (Work, School, Gym) during my property search

So that the search results display the travel distance from the property to the places that matter most to me.

Acceptance Criteria:

- **Given** the user is on the property search page, **When** they open the advanced filters, **Then** they see a "Places of Interest" section with text inputs for specific addresses or coordinates.
- **When** the search results render, **Then** each property card includes a small map or tag showing the calculated distance (e.g., "5km to Work", "2km to School").
- **Edge Case:** If the map API fails to calculate the distance, the UI should gracefully fallback to displaying "Distance unavailable" rather than breaking the property card layout.